

Finding the right partner: While Red Bull's dominance stemmed from the brilliance of Max Verstappen, who clinched his fourth consecutive title, it found itself grappling again with a familiar issue — its second driver. PICS: GETTY IMAGES



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For Liam Lawson, stepping into the Red Bull cockpit is not just a golden opportunity but a litmus test of **monumental proportions.**

Kavita Menon

kavita.menon@thehindu.co.in

In Formula One, consistency is as crucial as the ability to adapt to the unpredictable, which was the deciding factor in the World Constructors' Championship battle of 2024. The eventual winner, McLaren, was one of only two teams to score points every weekend, alongside third-placed Red Bull, but their paths to this achievement were quite different.

While McLaren's resurgence was built on steady progress and team effort, Red Bull's dominance stemmed from the brilliance of Max Verstappen, who clinched his fourth consecutive title. However, the Milton Keynes-based outfit found itself grappling with a familiar issue — its second driver.

Sergio Perez, once Red Bull's perfect second fiddle, experienced a significant drop in performance and pace this season. Although under contract until 2026, the Mexican was eventually shown the door, bringing an end to a four-year partnership that delivered two constructors' titles. His departure meant a driver from the junior team, Racing Bulls, was primed to get the promotion.

Just a day after his exit, it was announced that Liam Lawson (**left**) would take his place in 2025. For many, it was unexpected to see

